



New Learner Information Package

Full Stack Developer Program
Cohort 14

February 2025 - August 2025

Please click the links below and read through all sections of this package. If you have any questions, reach out to info@inceptionu.com.

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Welcome from our Co-Founders

Welcome to the Full Stack Developer program at InceptionU! We are thrilled that you have made the decision to join us for the next 6 months to explore, to be curious, and ultimately, to learn. At InceptionU, we believe that learning is not an event but rather a journey, one that is constantly evolving, shifting, and requiring us to adapt. We specifically design our learning experiences to support people in becoming future fit, essentially, to be fit for the future without fearing it. Over the course of the next 6 months, you have an incredible opportunity to see the world from a new perspective and to create your career path (and learning path), one that is meaningful to you and that will have a positive impact on the innovation ecosystem in Alberta. We ask that you embrace the entire experience, both essential and technical, and look forward to seeing what you build, create, and ultimately, design. Thank you for choosing to learn with us. I look forward to working and learning with you!

Thank you for joining our program. It is going to be an amazing experience and we are grateful for what you will bring to the learning, not just for yourself and your fellow learners but also the learning you bring to us. We built this model of learning on a foundation of reciprocity and feedback that continually adjusts to produce better experiences and outcomes. You bring something special that we always learn from and that helps us all find our successful footing in the future. As you engage with projects and concepts you've never seen before or dive into learning the vital competencies for the future (collaboration, critical, systems, creative, and computational thinking), always remember we are depending on the gift of your perspective and your curiosity. This is your invitation to be generous. It is all about outcomes - showing what you can do - and being active and generous is a big part of our collective success. See you soon!



Margo Purcell

Co-Founder & CEO
InceptionU



Greg Hart

Co-Founder & Facilitator
InceptionU

Program Details

When does the program start?

Cohort 14 of the Full Stack Developer Program begins on **Tuesday, February 18th, 2025** at **9am**.

Where do I need to go on the first day?

The InceptionU learning space is within the Calgary Central Library located at [800 3rd St SE](#), directly east of City Hall. **Please meet us outside of the front doors just before 9am**, you will see us beside the **InceptionU banner** and we will then take you up to the InceptionU space. If for some reason you are delayed in arriving, make your way to the 3rd floor and walk to the SE corner where you will see the **YELLOW** InceptionU door. It will be open for you to come on in!

How do I take transit to the InceptionU space?

We recommend downloading the [Transit](#) app (available for iOS or Android) to help you navigate your way to the Calgary Central Library. Check out [Calgary Transit](#) for additional information.

Is there parking available for learners?

We do not provide parking for learners or staff, however, there is ample street parking available around the Calgary Central Library. Recommended spots to park are city lot 9055 or along 8th Ave between 4th and 5th St which are 9hr parking spots. Be sure not to park in the lots immediately to the east of the library as they are expensive.

Statutory Holidays and Program Break

The program observes the following statutory holidays and incorporates a one week break:

- April 18th - Good Friday
- Week of April 28th - May 2nd - Week-long session break
- May 19th - Victoria Day
- July 1st - Canada Day

IMPORTANT - How do I need to prepare?

Please set yourself up for success and continue to develop your Javascript knowledge with the course materials on Disco, our e-learning platform.

- Complete required **Technical preparation module on Disco** before Feb. 18th
- Complete required **Essential preparation module on Disco** before Feb. 18th
- Follow us on our social media channels

Complete Full Stack Developer's Disco Onboarding and Program Pre-work

To ensure a smooth start to the program, [set up your Disco account by clicking here](#) to dive into the pre-work and onboarding process of the '**Full Stack Developer Cohort 14**' before February 18th, 2025.

- **Your pre-course work** is located through the 'Learning' tab under 'Full Stack Developer Cohort 14'. Please complete the following before the start of the program to ensure successful set up.
 - Complete required **Technical preparation** before Feb. 18th (Located on Disco)
 - Complete required **Essential preparation** before Feb. 18th (Located on Disco)
- As our program also involves a significant focus on essential skills, please be sure to review the essential skills prep. **Essential skills and technical skills are both imperative to success in our program!** If you have finished all of the course materials, please let us know, and we will set you up with more. It is critical that you immerse yourself in code everyday. **Learning is not an event, it is a lifelong mindset.**

What do I need to bring on the first day?

Please bring your curious self, your laptop, and whatever you need to feel comfortable. There are coat racks as well as storage cubbies for your items or bags. We will provide coffee and snacks for everyone to celebrate the start of the program. We do have a large fridge in the space for learners and staff to use. There are various locations in the East Village where you can purchase lunch if needed including a Superstore just a few blocks away.

What will happen on the first day of the program?

The first day is dedicated to the cohort and InceptionU team to get to know one another, and set all learners up with access to the software we will use to communicate and learn throughout the program. Come with an open mind and sense of curiosity as you will be engaging in various activities as well as familiarizing yourself with the Central Library. You will all receive access cards as well for the secured InceptionU space.

We will guide you through the details of the program, format of delivery, and what you can expect for your learning routine. It is expected that all learners who are participating in the program are available **Monday through Friday every week between the hours of 9am and 4pm.**

Learners who have received government funding for program fees may meet Kate McNeil (Government of Alberta) early in the program. She will share why this funding has been provided to support Albertans in career transition into the tech/innovation space.

What are the minimum computer specifications for the program?

You will need a basic laptop that is capable of accessing the internet with audio and video capabilities. Most of the time you will be using online platforms and web-based programs so you do not need the most powerful machine out there. It can be very helpful to have a more modern laptop as you may need to run other tools such as Zoom while also working on other platforms at the same time and this can require system resources to manage them simultaneously. You can use Mac OS, Windows 10 or Linux operating systems. Each has their own advantages.

Here is an example of a good system for a software developer to use:

- Recent-gen i5 or greater, Ryzen 3000-series AMD or greater, or Apple Silicon (M1/M2)
- 8Gb RAM or higher
- Solid state hard drive (SSD) at least 500Gb
- Windows 10 / OS 11 or later
- Webcam or video access via laptop
- Headset / Microphone

*Please note that an iPad or Chromebook are not sufficient for our program.

Additional Program Information

Go Slow to Go Fast

What you can expect in the first weeks is a focus on you, understanding of core principles that apply across any field of endeavour and building related skills that will set the foundation for your learning in the Full Stack Developer program. Be prepared to dig in, to build self-knowledge of what you need to learn effectively, to establish what you expect from yourself over the course of this learning experience and to do so in non-traditional ways.

What can I expect at InceptionU?

At InceptionU, we are an adaptive and responsive learning environment. We have a framework that we will guide you through over the next 6 months and an overall cadence of learning sessions. Every two weeks the specifics of the curriculum and schedule are updated based on the needs of the learners, where you need additional support, and where you can stretch your learning. This will adapt along with the cohort and what is required from the projects.

New Era of Education

InceptionU, a non-profit organization, forgoes formal certification and accreditation, prioritizing a flexible curriculum aligned with industry needs. Our program emphasizes practical skills through software projects, team collaboration, and GitHub contributions, culminating in a digital portfolio. With a focus on project-based learning, we aim to build competence and essential skills, aligning with the World Economic Forum's future skills. While recognizing the importance of credentials in certain industries, InceptionU highlights the significance of mindset and competence for the evolving workplace. [Learn More](#)

What are the Contagious Illness Guidelines?

As with any significant health event, InceptionU has followed the health guidelines recommended by health experts and authorities. While COVID-19 and other contagious illnesses remain with us, we have **returned to an in-person delivery model, with opportunities to work virtually after a few months and teams are formed for project work.** For learners that have secured a funded seat, you are required, as a condition of your agreement with the government of Alberta, to be available to be in person in the InceptionU learning space from Monday to Friday from 9am - 4pm, for the duration of the cohort.

Post-Program Employment Reporting for Funded Seats

If you have received a government-funded seat in the Full Stack Developer program, **it is required as a condition of receiving said funding that you will report your employment status and subsequent details for three (3) months after completion of the program.** If you secure employment, you are required to inform InceptionU through an employment reporting form that will be sent out. Additionally, InceptionU will reach out once per month for three months to check in on a) if you're employed, b) the details of said employment, and if you've already reported employment, c) checking in at three months to confirm current status of employment.

Additional Resources Available

English as a Second Language Support

In order to ensure that you are set up for success while participating in InceptionU programming, one of our trained staff is available to provide any language support that would be helpful, through one-on-one meetings. Reach out to any of the InceptionU team members to learn more.

Laptop Accessibility

If situations arise that you are unable to provide your own laptop for use during the program due to financial reasons, a limited number of loaner laptops are able to be loaned out. This is done on a case-by-case basis. Contact your program steward if there is a need.

Mental Health Support

InceptionU has partnered with Calgary Counselling Centre to provide learners access to mental health support for the duration of the program, if needed. More details on how to utilize this resource will be provided on our LMS platform, Disco, at the start of your program.

Follow us on social media

The best time to get started on your networking is **NOW**. Follow us on our social channels below:

- [LinkedIn](#)
- [Twitter](#)
- [Instagram](#)

It is also recommended that you follow these ecosystem LinkedIn profiles as well:

- [Platform Calgary](#)
- [Tech West Collective](#)